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我是跟德亚
指挥官。

有这么一个头衔…
我看你是个负责人？

你对
莫涅夫博士
做了什么？

不用
担心他。

你应该
担心你
自己。

老实待着
别动。

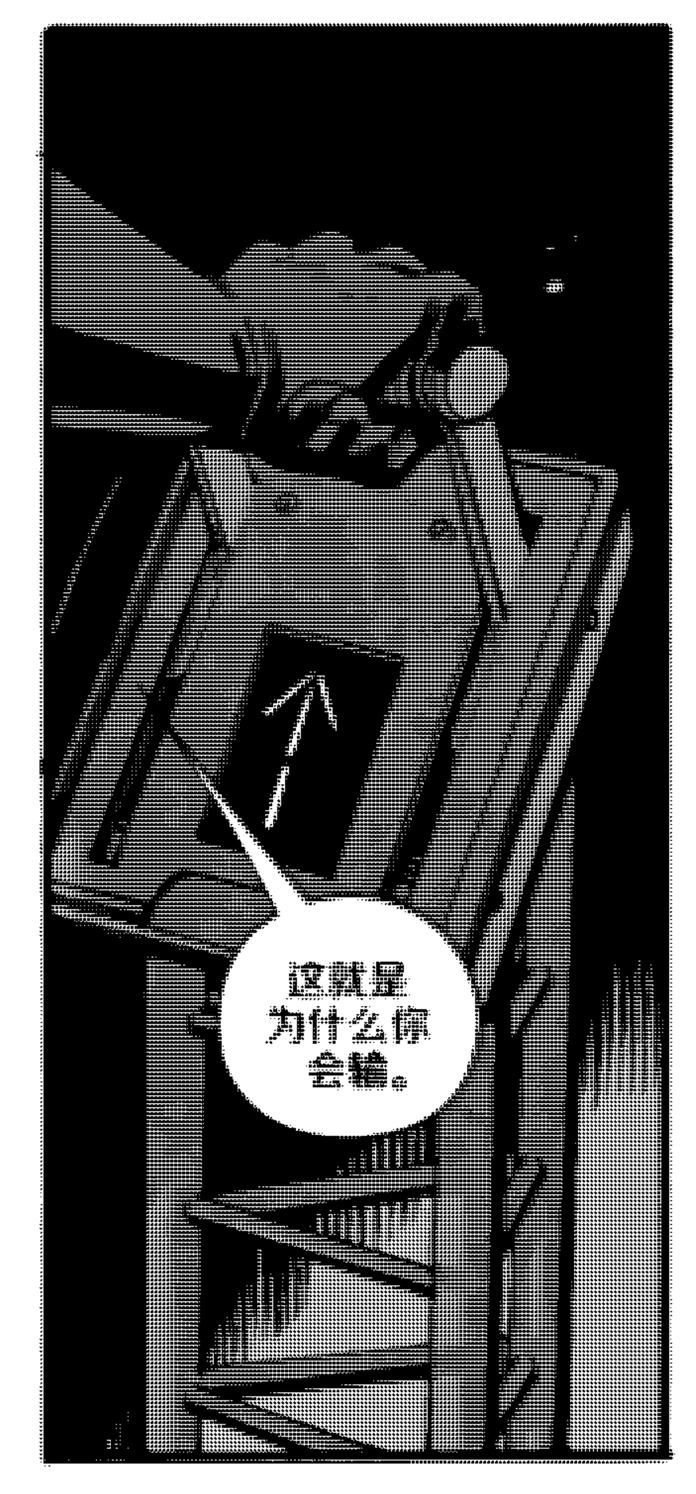
我很高兴，
我们终于面对面了，
公爵。

你怎么知道
我的名字？

迪斯特罗
跟我说过你。

我必须要说，
你和我
非常相似…

“我们都曾忠于某个比我们自身更伟大的存在。”
“最终为其事业牺牲一切。”
“如今我们都被遗弃在一边。”
“然而，当你爬到你主子的脚下时，发现缺了一块脆的东西。”
“被迫去寻找替罪羊，寻找一个安身立命的新角色。”
“比我之前猜的更有价值…”
“即便现在看来，你身边似乎有人帮你跨一步实现你的个人愿望。”



住手!
我开枪了!

不,你不会。
你需要我活着。
我是唯一一个知晓你
心心念念的机器人的
真相的人…

感染弹将在5分钟内爆炸。
当它爆炸的时候，它会杀死附近区域的所有人，然后五英里内的每个人都会变成忠实信徒，直到…
立刻关停它。
公爵，欢迎你来试试。但是现在关掉它的唯一办法就是干掉这位莫涅夫博士。
我见到过一线希望，我找到了一个值得挑战的对手。
但这就是结局。
再见。
很抱歉让你失望了，但是你哪儿也去不了！
BANG
BANG
BANG

17.
"15种部队
跑不了的！"

你以为你们能打了我，再看那玩意逃之夭夭？

迪斯特罗爵士不是好惹的！

男爵夫人，我们得回去救公爵。我们不能丢下他不管。

我们连眼镜蛇都还没甩掉呢，而你想要我这回头去自投罗网？！

为了你，公爵会这么干的。

因为他是个傻子！

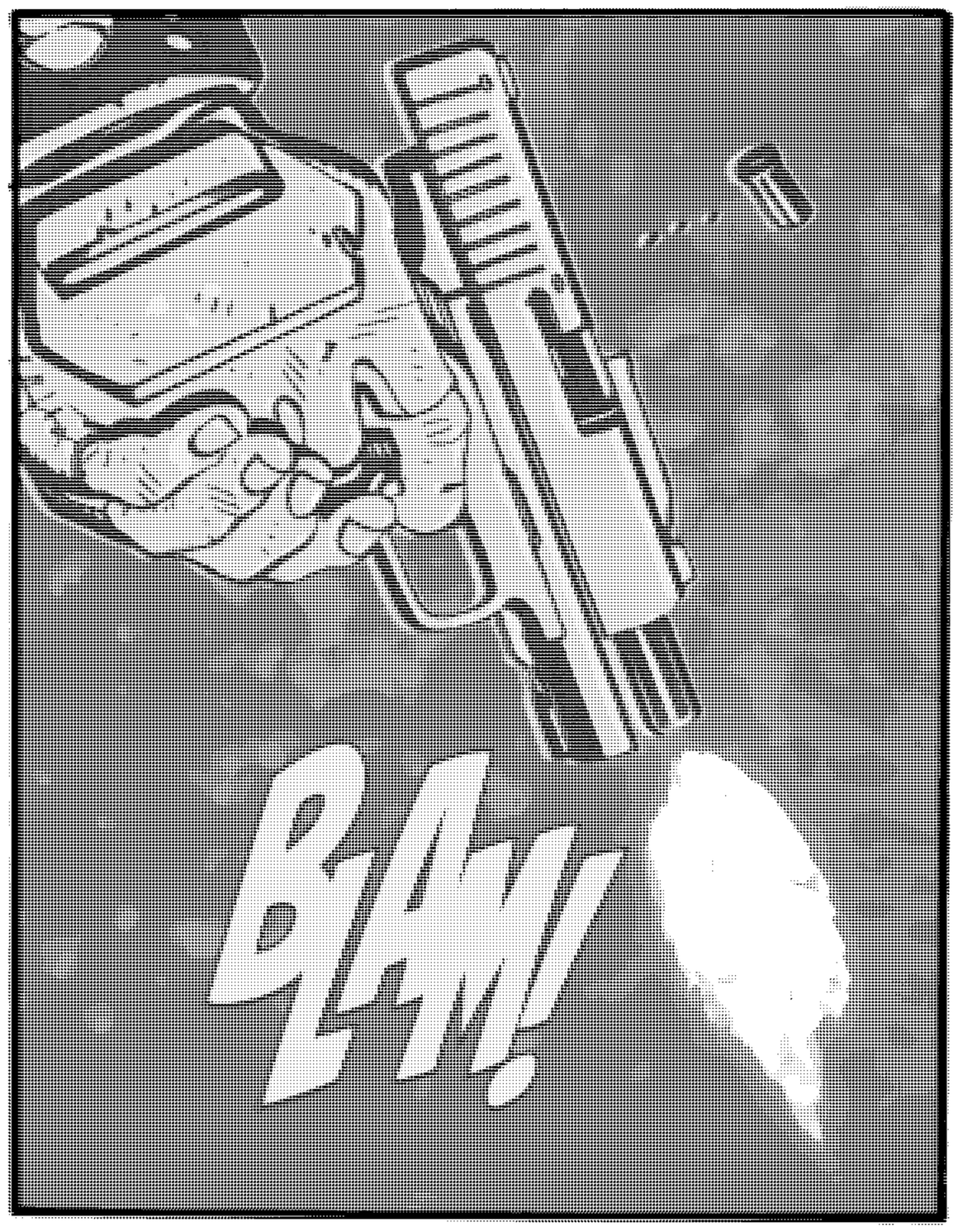
男爵夫人…阿纳斯塔西娅。

我从没当你是个打退堂鼓的人。

他们怎么一？

T-02
嗯？
迪斯尼，宝贝。
嗯，他干的好事？我正在阻止特种部队逃走，可是…
那这个问题就让它自生自灭吗。
告诉所有人，掩蔽信号，回主基地。
我们会用上。

ARM
KLIK


ПРИВЕТ!

ЧЕ!

ПАЖЕТ!

公爵，你得明白你完蛋了。

你应该带着活下去，改日再战的念想一走了之的。

我不需要和你打。

我只需要让你在炸弹附近待足够长的时间，以确保它爆炸的时候…你也会死。

我不怕死！

也许你不怕死，但是当炸弹爆炸时…你的眼镜蛇帝国成事了，眼镜蛇成了世界的领导者。

要是你看不懂了…

你能甘心去死？

BAST!

你在什么？！

我高估过你。
关掉炸弹，乖乖献宝。

你这混蛋！

SHINGG

SLASH!!

你逼我的。

DEEP

TESSHHH

!!

他们跑是因为我下的命令。

你早该跑的。

和你的同伙一样。

T-03

好在他们不听我的。

所有马尔斯产业已被充公。

我们打赢打水一场空！我们所做的一切是向特种部队……自报家门！

并非如此。

我们实测了我们的新武器，获悉了我们的士兵和盟友的战备情况，向世界表明我们的可怕之处。

现在我们知道了谁在对抗我们。

我清楚后果。

指挥官，我烦透了这些把戏。

你在撒谎。

你在隐瞒什么。我会想办法把它从你的灵魂里扯出来。

我提醒过你，你之所以这么知道内情，是因为我允许你这样做。

你说完了？

是的。

很好。

我需要莫涅夫和他的脑波扫描仪与外星科技碎片相结合，而不仅仅是脑波炸弹。

这是为了解锁一块隐藏在里面的，我无法单独访问的东西。搞定——

呃？
另一种武器？
比那还厉害。
迪斯特罗，也许是时候告诉你真相了。
关于即将到来的…
和已经到来的战争。

“我们输了。”

“话下来就好。”

“长官，并非人人如此。”

“这就是战争，公园，这个例清楚。”

我清楚得很，霍克上校。

我想过你说的话。你说我必须接纳团队的个体个性。

当我们背水一战的时候，我从未绝望。是因为其他的成员。为了确保大家活着离开战场，他们各显其能。

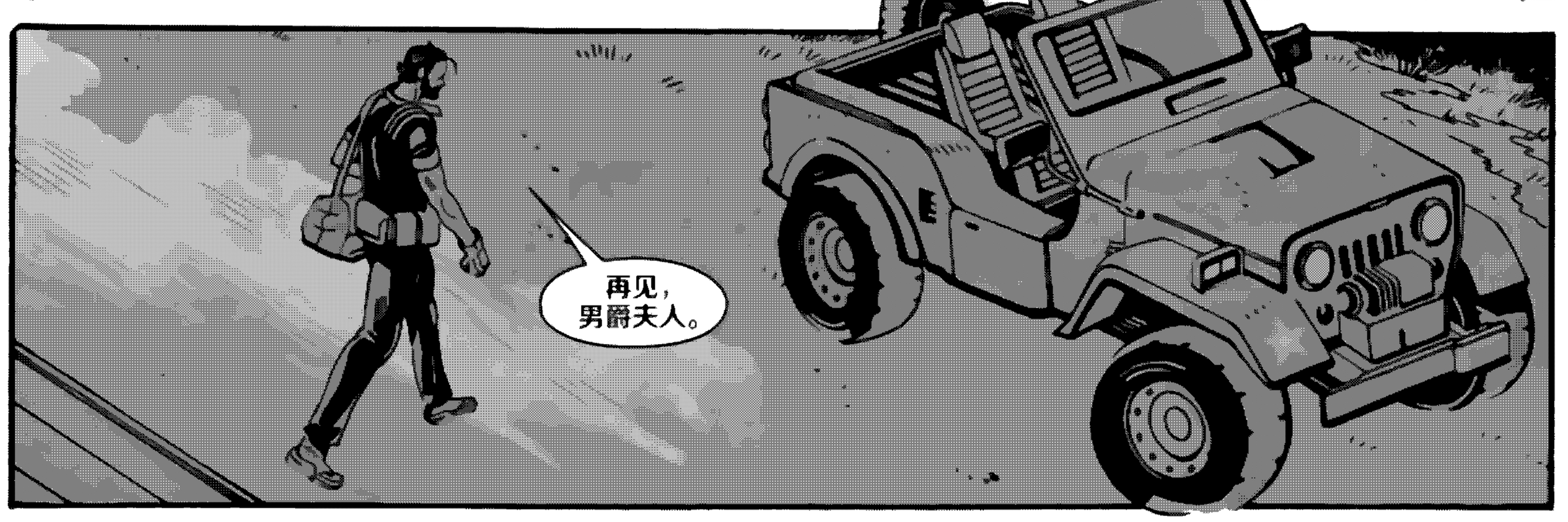
“我们需要更多的训练。更多的时间一起上战场。”

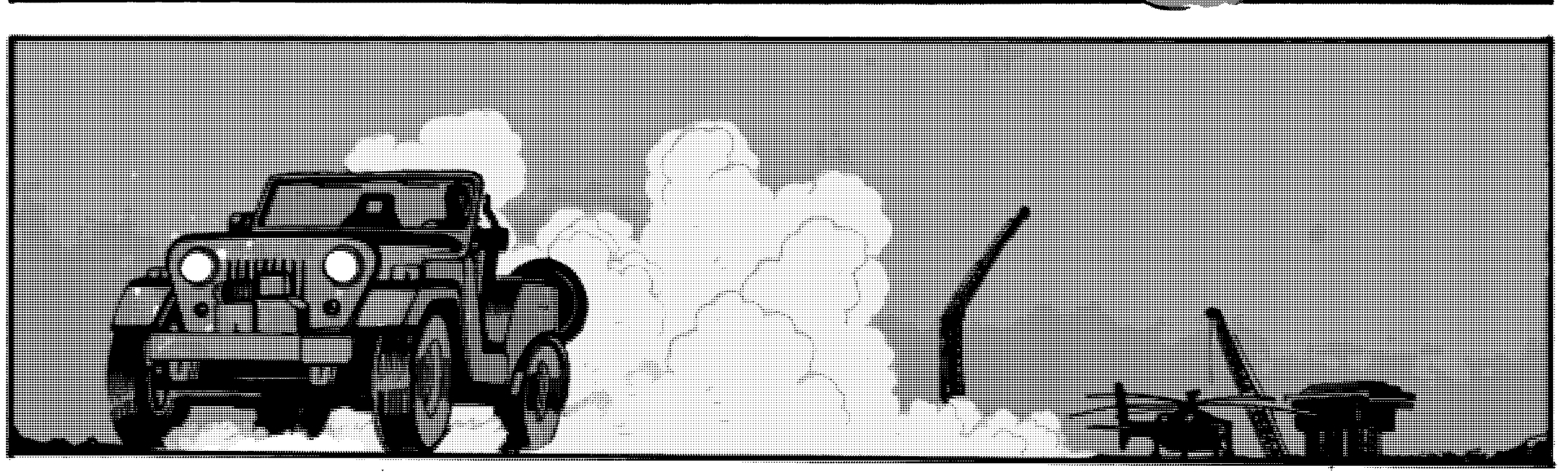
我有一种感觉，眼镜蛇会为我们提供足够的历练。

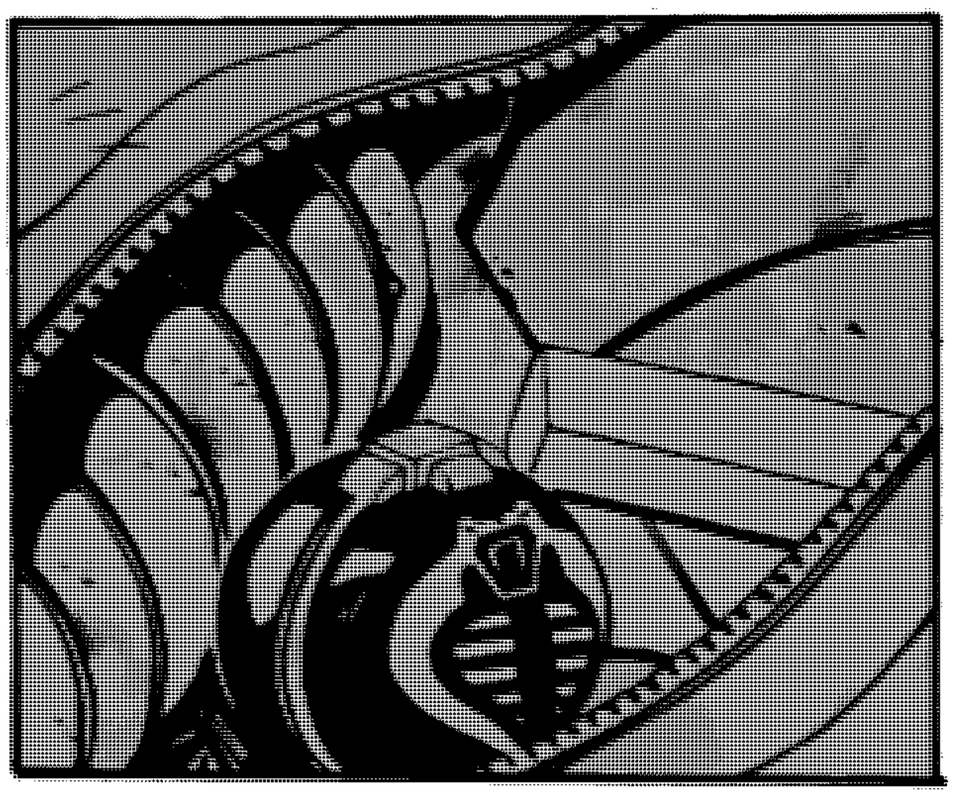
但是，长官，对我来说，重要的是，我们不能失去成立这支队伍的初衷…

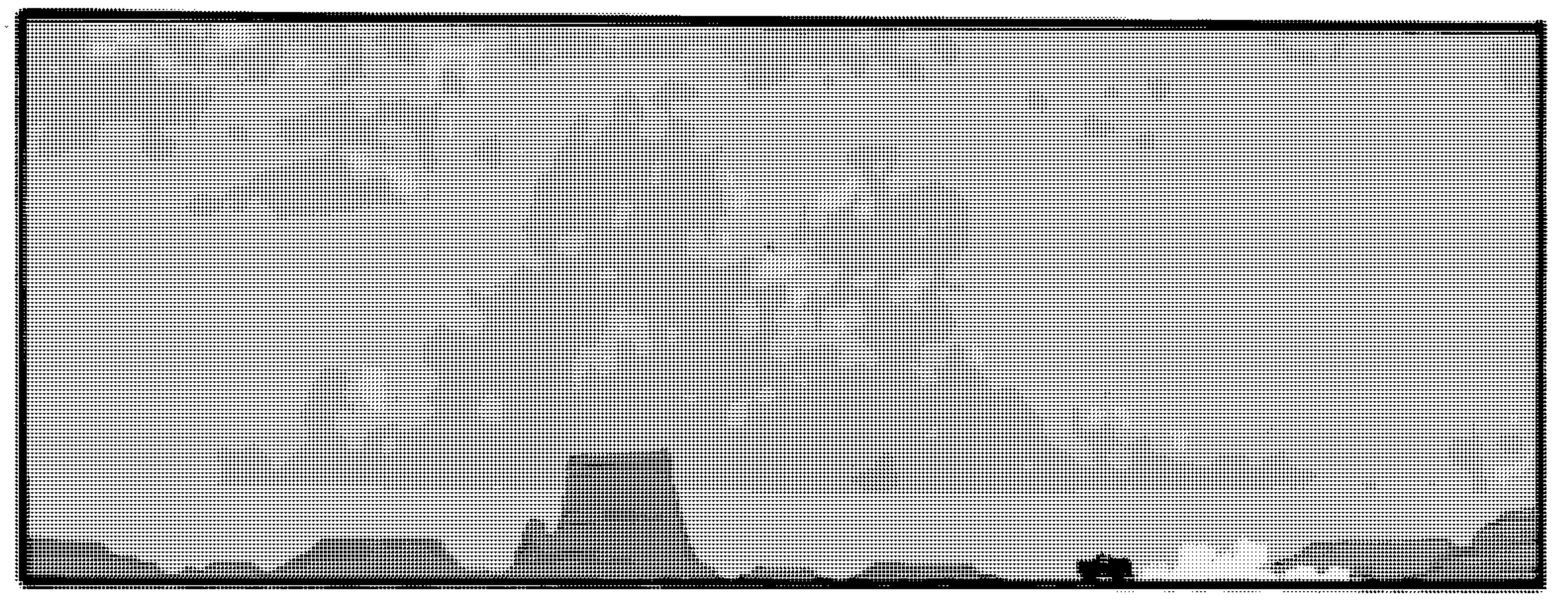
“我们得找到杀害我的战友的机器人…”
这回舒服多了。
眼镜蛇那身行头挺刺挠的。

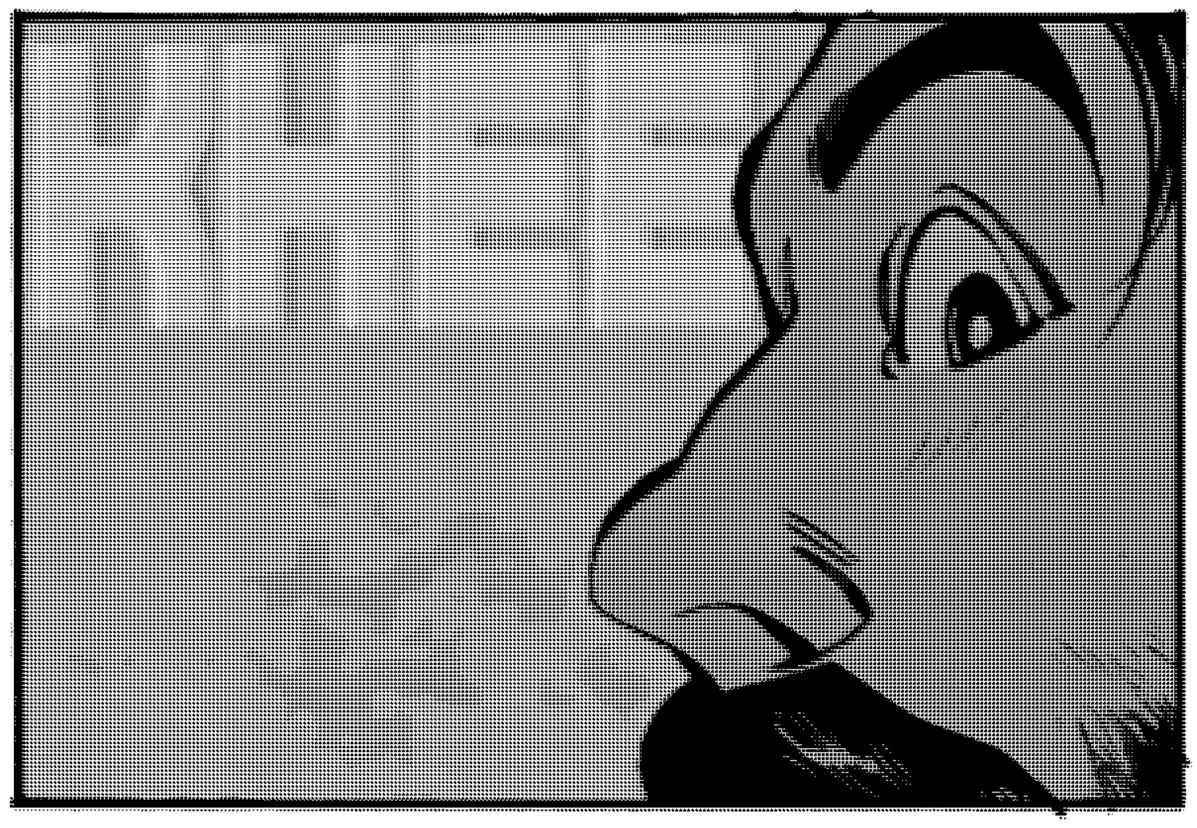
克拉奇，你被准许离开大坑了？
我必须得开车兜兜风。理清一下头绪。
卧底在眼镜蛇太难了。我随时都觉得他们要抓我。我只是…我需要放松一下。你知道吧？

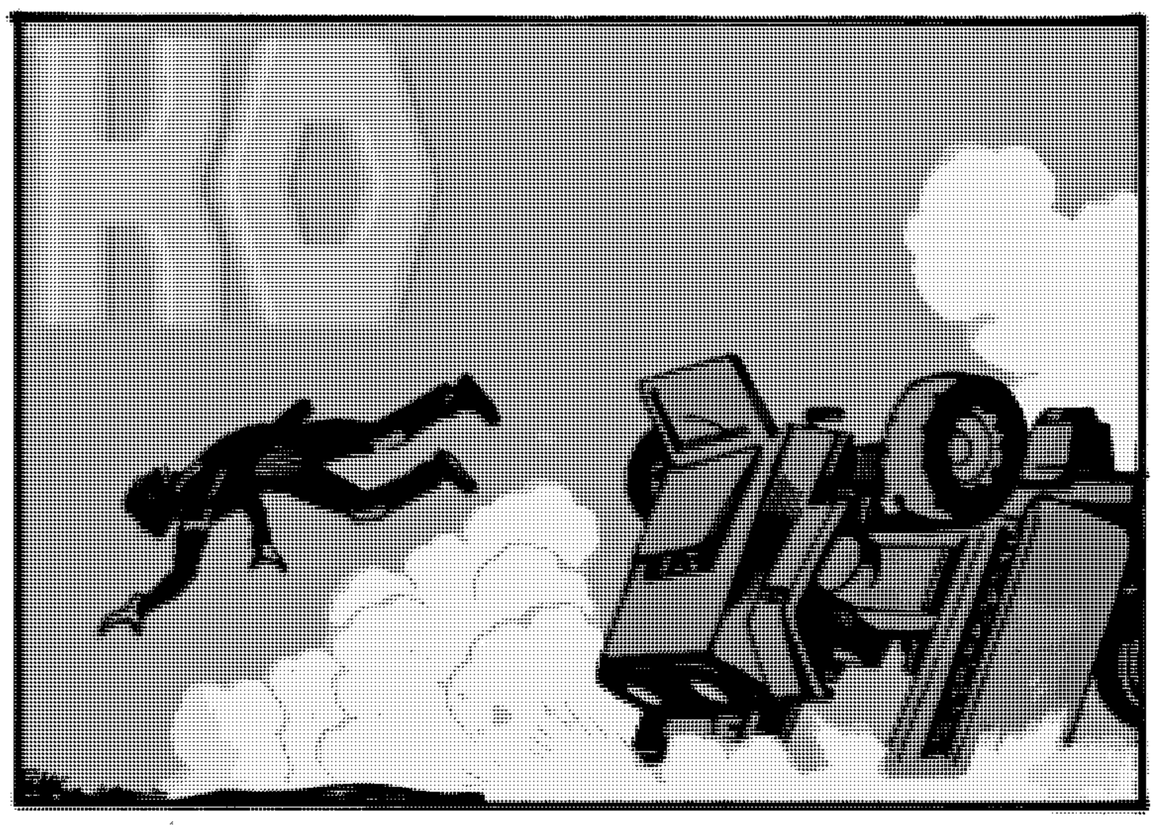

再见，男爵夫人。

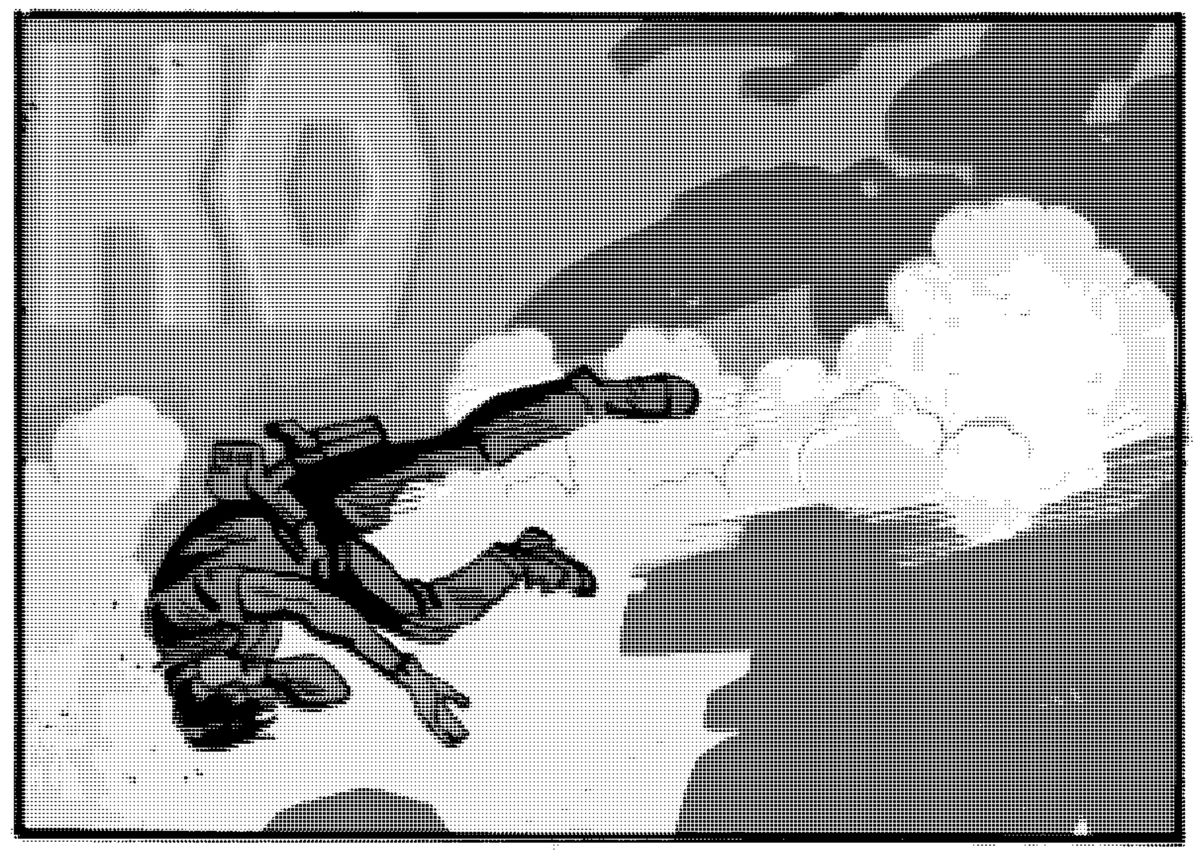


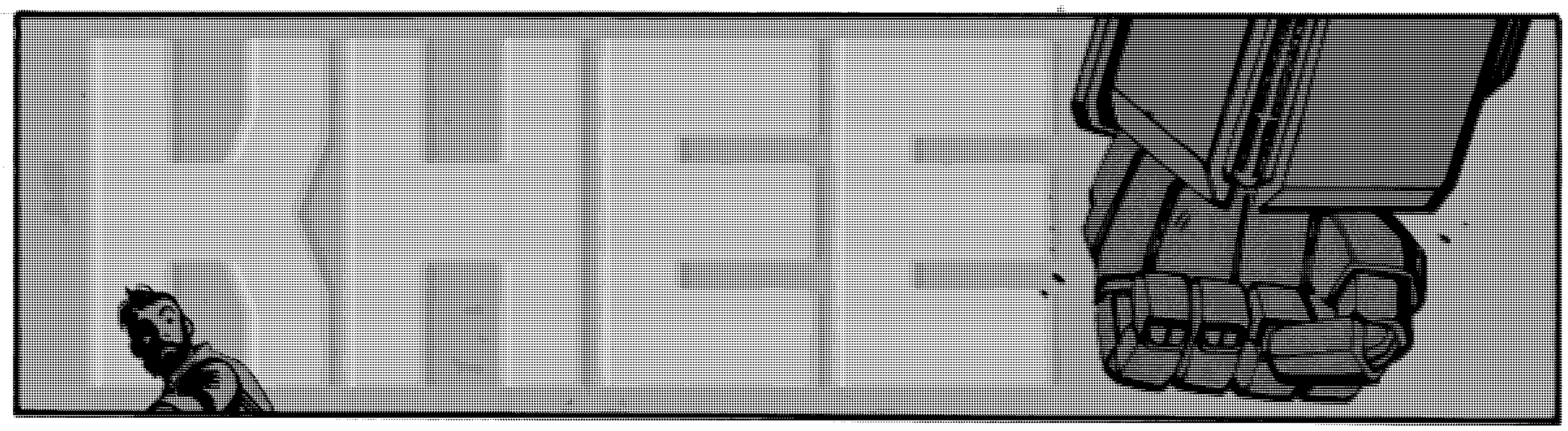












嗯，快什么

And BOOM, we've reached the end of another incredible arc with Robert, Lorenzo, Patricio and Rus once again absolutely crushing it! Editor Ben Abernathy, at your service, and excited to dive into the mail bag with the Battle Beast himself, Robert Kirkman!

Before we dive into the mail, I want to take a moment to thank co-creator and artist Lorenzo De Felici for his EXCELLENT work on the past 18 issues. And under some less than ideal circumstances, as I'm often late with scripts. Every amazing thing you've seen in these issues from the many worlds we've seen, to the amazing new characters and vehicles and so much world building has all come from his brain. It's been an absolute blast to have the honor of working with him again and I look forward to our next collaboration.

If you haven't gathered by now, this will be Lorenzo's last issue of the series (for now) as he takes a sabbatical to develop some other stellar work. I'm hoping he'll grace these pages with his talents again sooner rather than later, if we're lucky.

Next issue we'll be welcoming aboard the mega-talented Conor Hughes who I couldn't be more thrilled to be working with. You've seen his work on quite a few Void Rival's covers already, so I'm sure you're as excited as I am. I've been a fan of Conor's work for quite some time, but more on him next issue.

NOW let's dive into the mail!

Hi V-R team!

I don't ever really write fan mail, nor do I really read it much at the end of books that have it, but I just really had to let you know that I really appreciate all you're doing with Void Rivals, and I don't mean the whole Transformers/G.I. Joe universe. I only watched those casually when I was a kid in the 80s, and it is pretty cool to see them taking new life in these pages, but what really keeps me tied to this comic series is the multifaceted story and crisp and expressive artwork. I've been reading comics since the early 90s and I've started and stopped lots of series. Void Rivals had me hooked right away, and again, not because of the overall Energon Universe. It's the whole enemies becoming friends thing, hope for an alliance between two peoples, tip-toeing around a potential romance, true sci-fi fun, and the really unique ideas without seeming gimmicky. Every issue draws me in every month! I have a hard time with on-going series--I forget what happened in the last month--but not with V-R. I always remember and I'm always eager to read it! I really appreciate the hard work you put in to make it accessible with limited knowledge of its ties, as well. Amazing work overall! A true sci-fi masterpiece and a testament to what comics can be!

Sincerely,

Mike Flynn

Thank you for writing in, Mike, and for your continued support and enthusiasm for VOID RIVALS. We wouldn't be closing out our 18th issue without fans like you. And I hope you check out this particular letter column to see your printed letter!

Yes, thanks Mike! Obligatory response to say that while I appreciate the love for Void Rivals, you really should give the wider Energon Universe a quick look. What the teams are doing in both TRANSFORMERS and G.I. JOE is really cool. If you like Void Rivals I do feel like you'll enjoy those books!

Dear Kirkman and Company,

How?! How could you do that to Skuxxoid! Don't you know he has a wife and kids to provide for! All jokes aside, if you'd told me a couple of years ago when this book started that the death of a character like Skuxxoid would be an emotional gut punch, I would have called you crazy, but here we are at Void Rivals #16. I would argue this is the most emotional death in the EU thus far. We only had Rock 'N' Roll for 6 issues, and Ratchet for only 7 or 8 issues, but we've had Skuxxoid since issue 2, that's 15 issues! Not to mention he was the VR front runner for the FCBD Special. He had a sad arc and I'm sad to see him go, but I do find it poetic justice that he died gun in hand, on his Rockeroid, just like we met him all those months ago.

Until next time, Roll Out!

Bret M.

I share your sentiments with our dearly departed Skuxxoid, Bret, and I hope he finds the peace in death he sought so desperately in life. R.I.P. (Rest In Pieces)

I think it's become pretty clear how much we love Skuxxoid around these parts. At times he's fighting for the lead spot in this series! His death is a real bummer... but I promise you'll enjoy the next issue... sad as it might be!

Hello Void Rivals Team,

Life-long Skuxxoid fan here, I've been absolutely loving the comic so far. The overall setting is very close to that of Transformers Season 3 (the best season), which I think has been severely underrepresented. This comic, along with the others in the Energon Universe, have pretty much completely rebooted my view of comics as a medium. Anyways, I just finished reading issue 16. I may never

forgive you.

Keep up the great work, all!
Arren Meuchel

As long you keep reading and enjoying the Energon Universe, Arren, I can live without your forgiveness! (But I think you'll forgive us heh heh)

Loving all this Skuxxoid love! He was a cool visual I remembered from watching the Transformers show as a kid and I must say... he's really grown into one of my favorite characters ever... which, I know, makes my treatment of him seem strange. It is what it is. You guys really need to get our next issue.

I must admit, I'm still impressed by the new "Visionaries Easter Egg" in Void Rivals #17, besides Zerta Trion's true identity, as well as the next arc of Daniel Warren Johnson in Transformers, the end of the first arc in G.I. Joe, and the upcoming A Real American Hero: Silent Missions one-shots. (About the last series, I still try to understand it, because it continues from the original comics by Marvel and IDW).

Anyway, thank you for what you're doing. The future toy line for SDCC 2025 is sublime.

See you next time.

Sincerely,
Fico

Thank YOU for supporting the Energon Universe, Fico, and for your sharp eye in VOID RIVALS #17...

No comment!

Dear Handroid,

I love, love, love Void Rivals! However, there are also lots and lots of characters, and sometimes it's hard to keep track of everyone's name.

Any chance we can get a "Roster" page at the beginning or end of each issue showing a picture of the main characters and their names?

Keep rocking it!
Jesse

Hmm... an interesting idea.

I wouldn't be opposed to something like that. At the very least, maybe a nice feature for a quickly approaching anniversary issue.

Howdy fellas!

So, I sent in a letter before, way back around issue #9 or so. It got published in issue #11, actually. I was the lad who very nervously asked about the Junkions.

Considering the cover previews that got released yesterday (I'm writing this on the morning of the 19th) I just had to send in another letter.

I'm beyond overjoyed. I actually don't think I can express how excited I am to see Wreck-Gar and the other Junkions and to find out how they play a part (however small it may be, I'll still appreciate it) in the story. I genuinely didn't think it would happen, but Robert's unusually optimistic reply the first time gave me a lot of hope. I don't think a lot of people can say that the Junkions are their favourite characters in Transformers, but I can, and I'm absolutely over the moon! Safe to say I'll be doing my best to pick a physical copy for my shelf!

Also, I've been convinced to start reading and watching Invincible based on how much I've enjoyed the Transformers and Void Rivals comics, and though I'm late to the game with that franchise, I'm loving it so far! Lots of luck and support for the next issues of the Energon universe!

From Joey

All I can say, Joey, is YOU'RE WELCOME!

This is all great to hear, Joey! And thanks for trying INVINCIBLE! To any fans out there, we are planning for this Energon Universe to stand the test of time. That's our goal. So, if all goes according to plan... you'll see... pretty much everything eventually. It may take time... but don't worry Cosmos fans... we'll get there eventually!

And once again, we draw this letter column to a close... be sure to pick up the ENERGON UNIVERSE SPECIAL/FCBD issue in a few weeks to get a hint of what's to come... and then VOID RIVALS #19 kicks off a thrilling new arc and as Robert mentioned, the arrival of Conor Hughes on art... it's gonna be EPIC!

-Ben

It's going to be great!! So much cool stuff on the horizon! Hoo boy! I need to get back to work on these scripts! Yikes!!

-Robert

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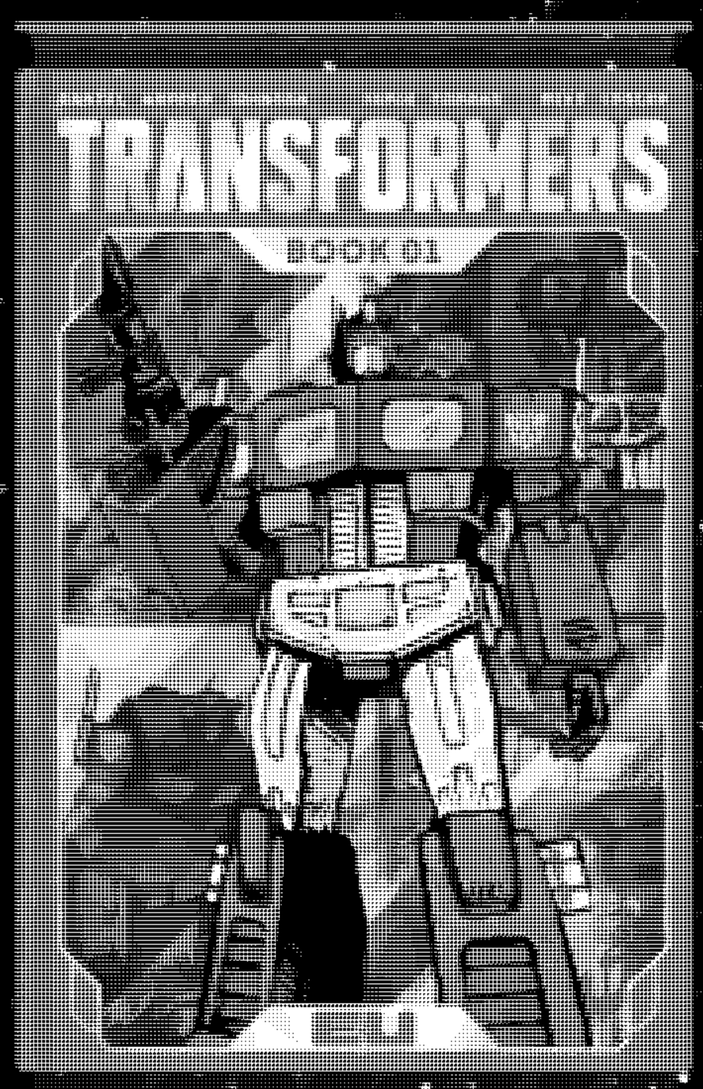

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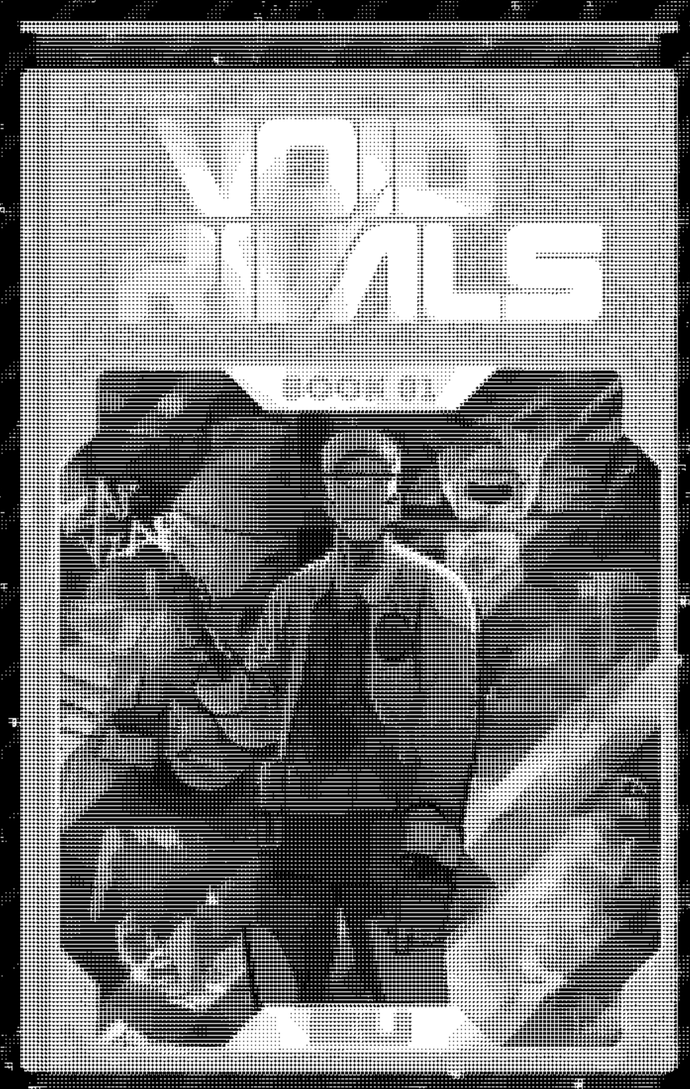

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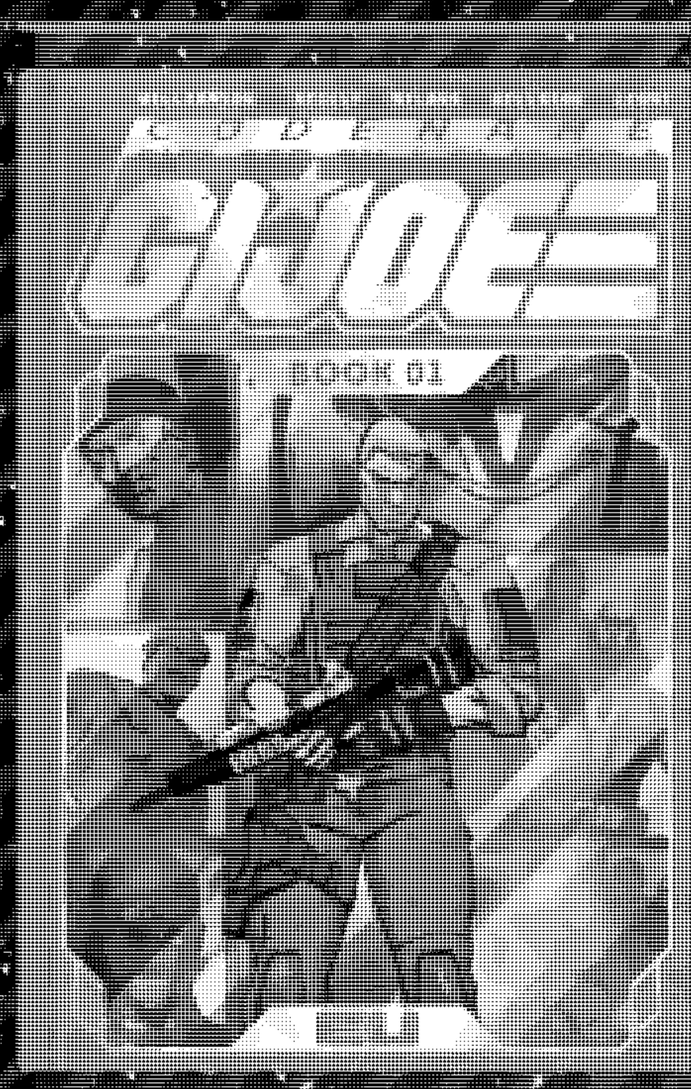

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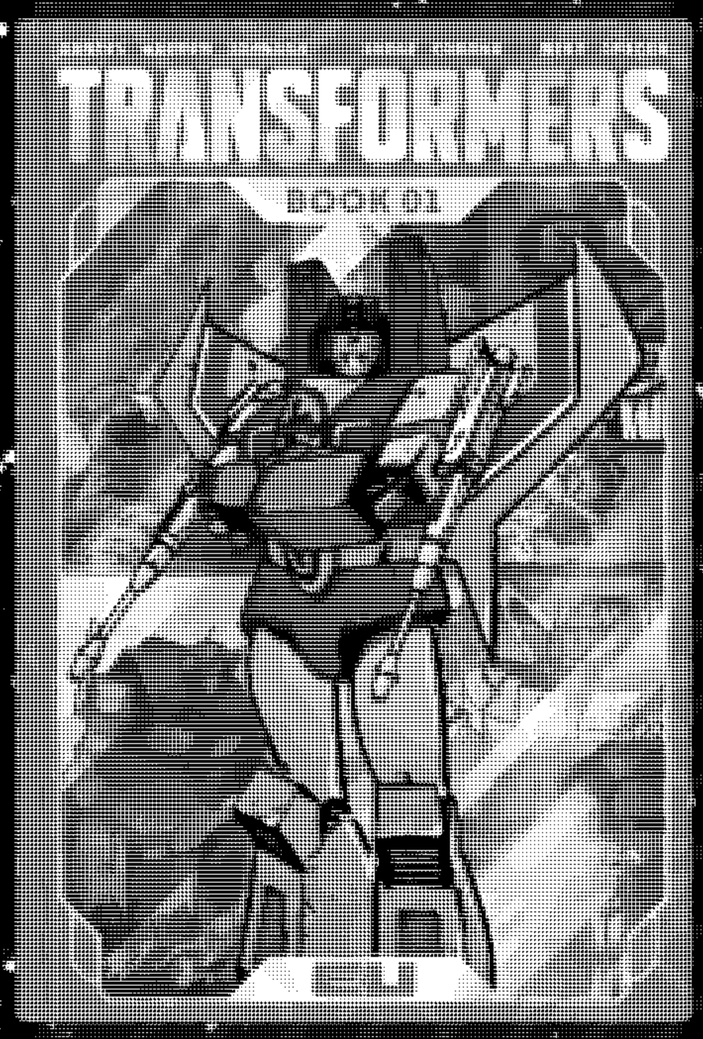

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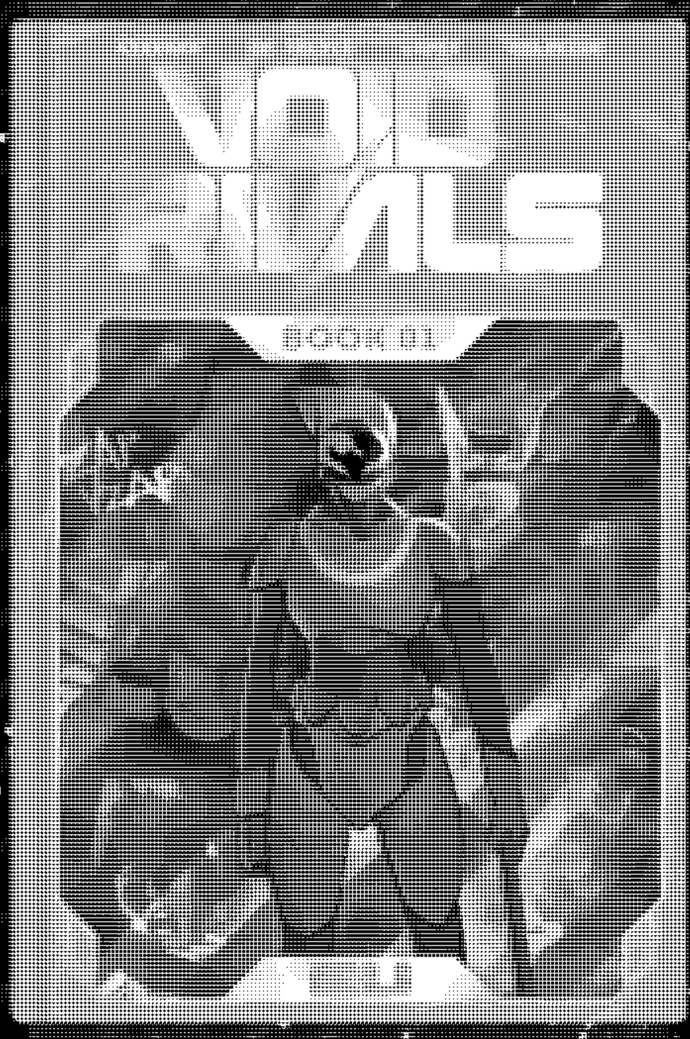

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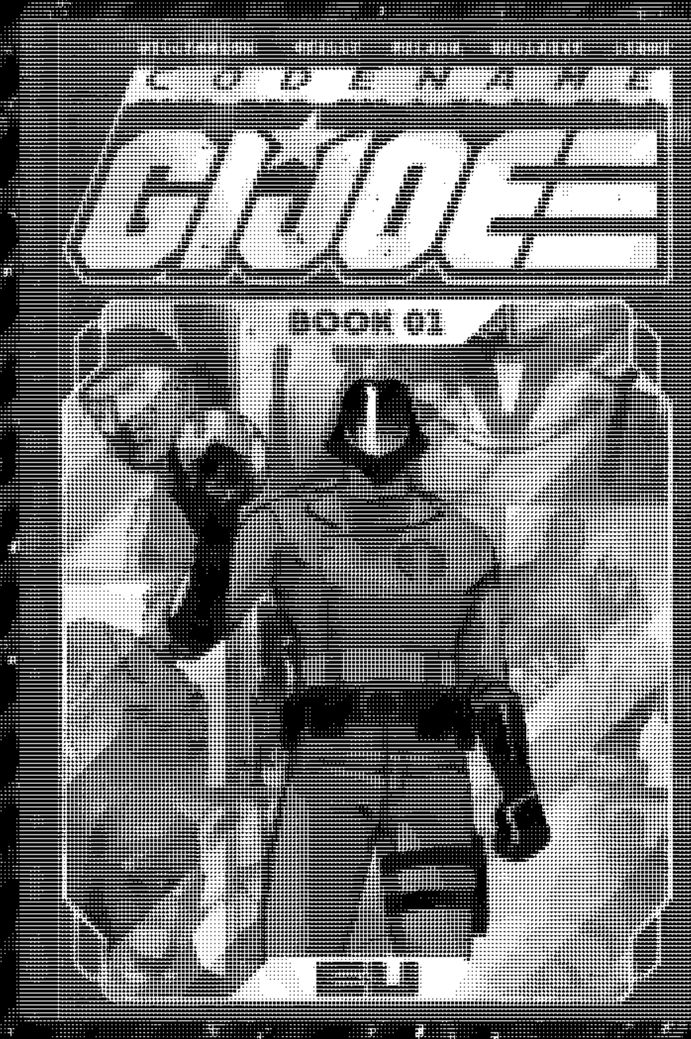

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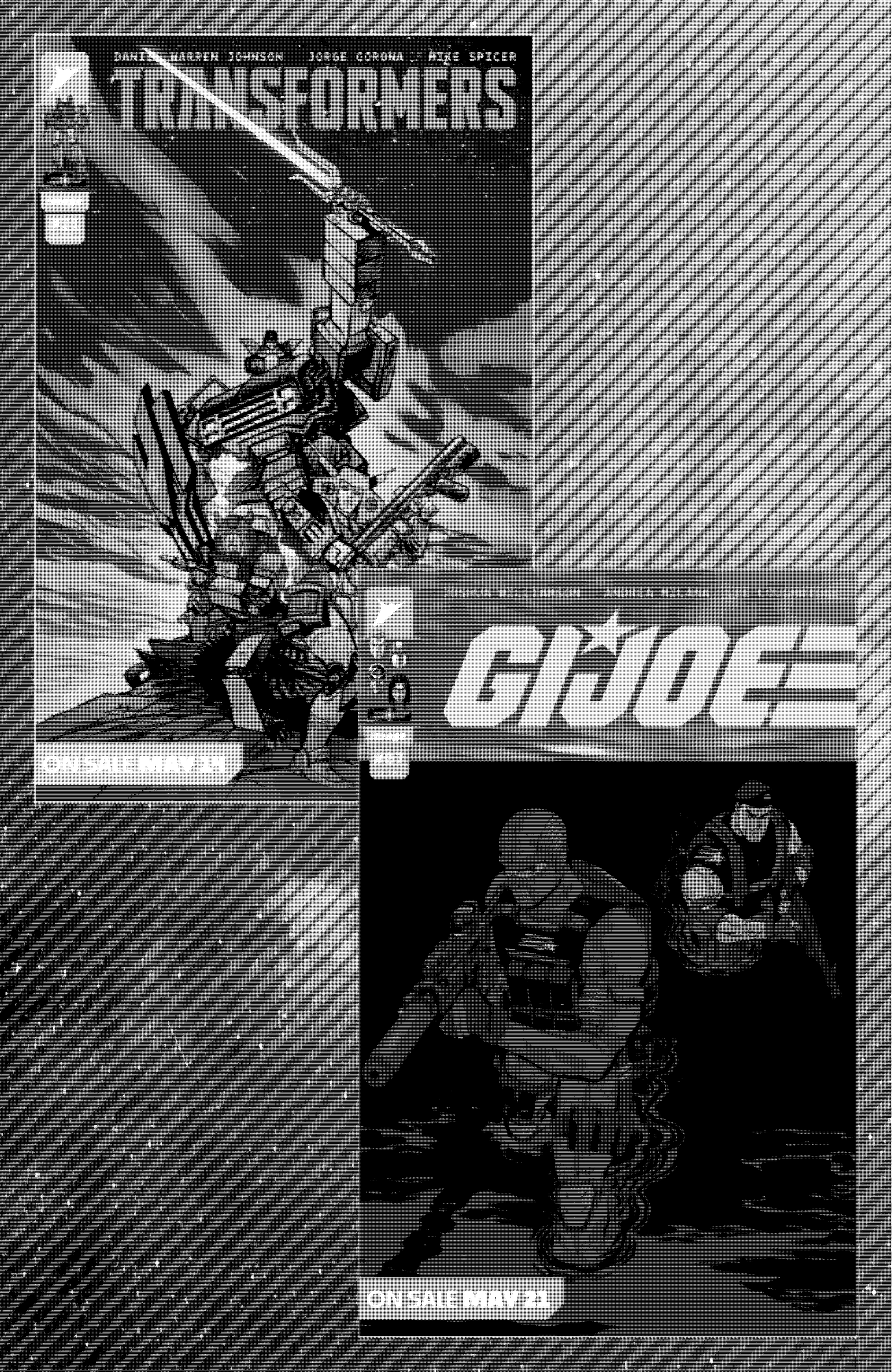
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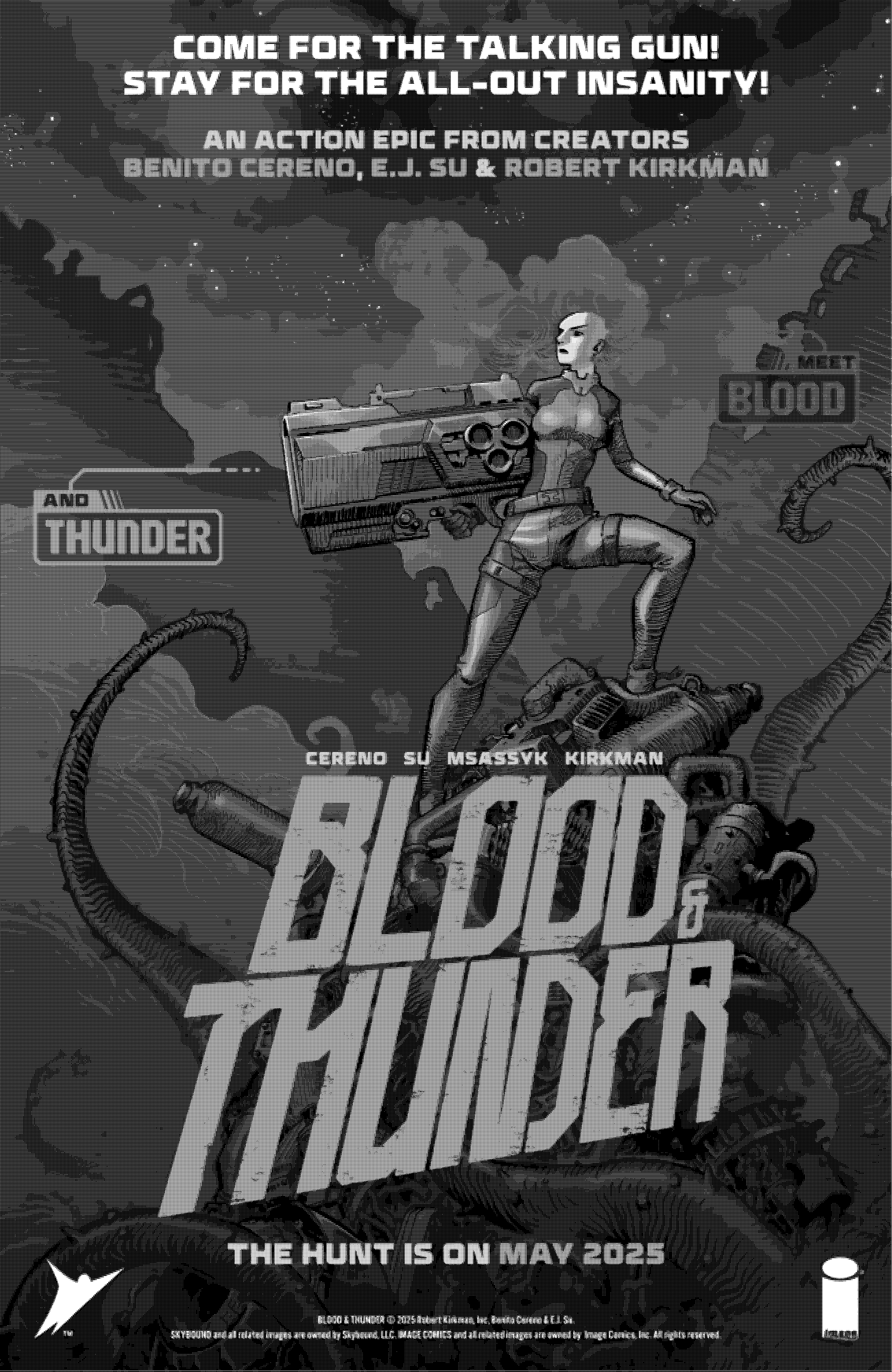

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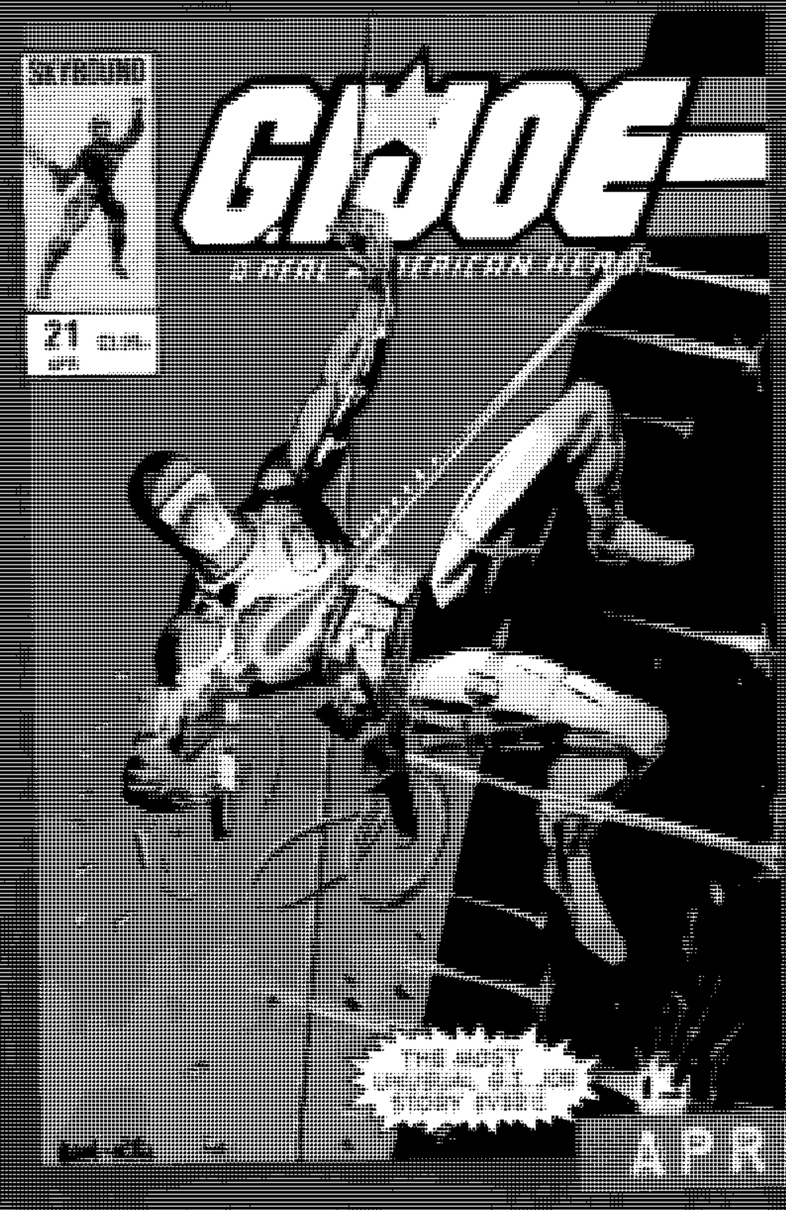

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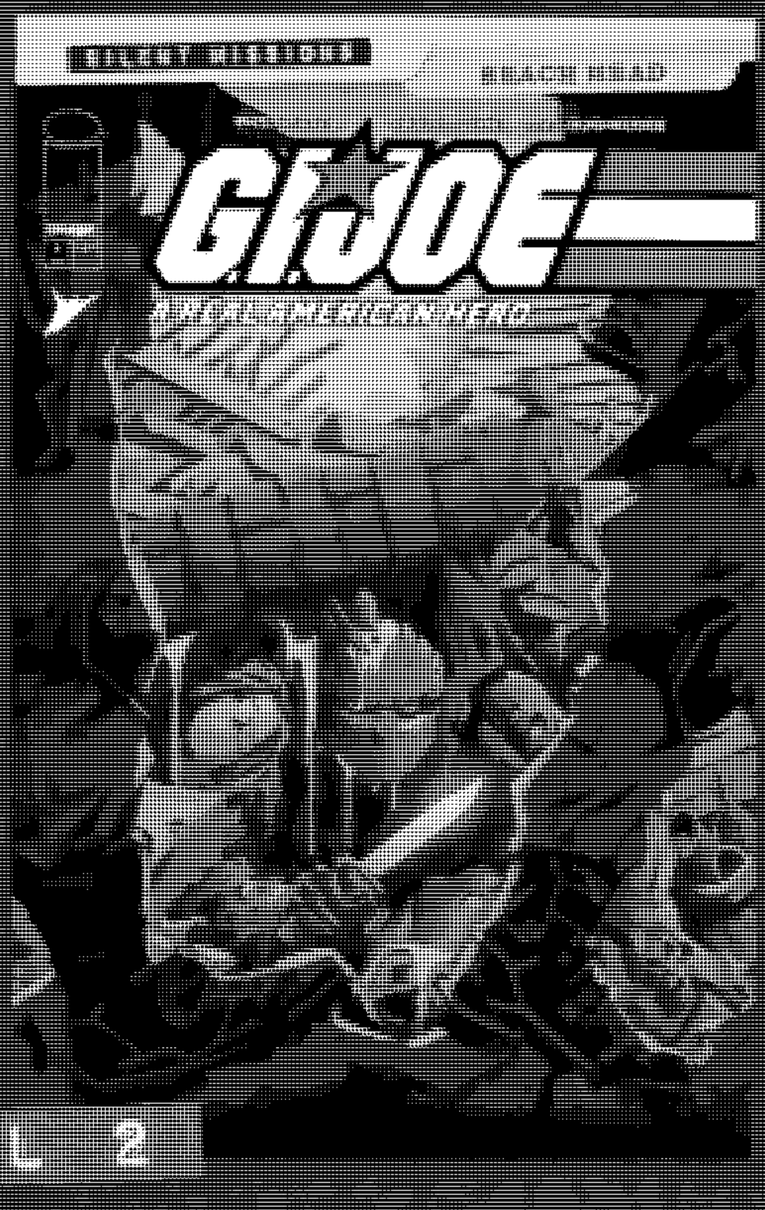

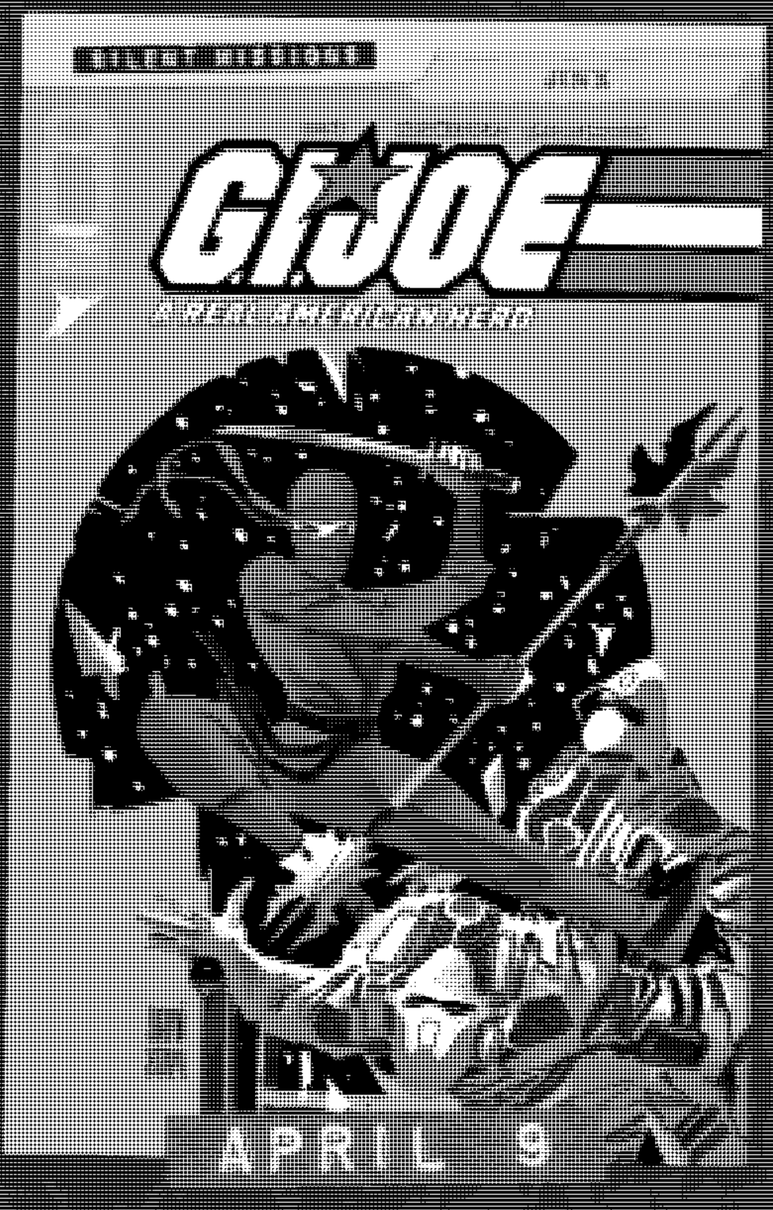

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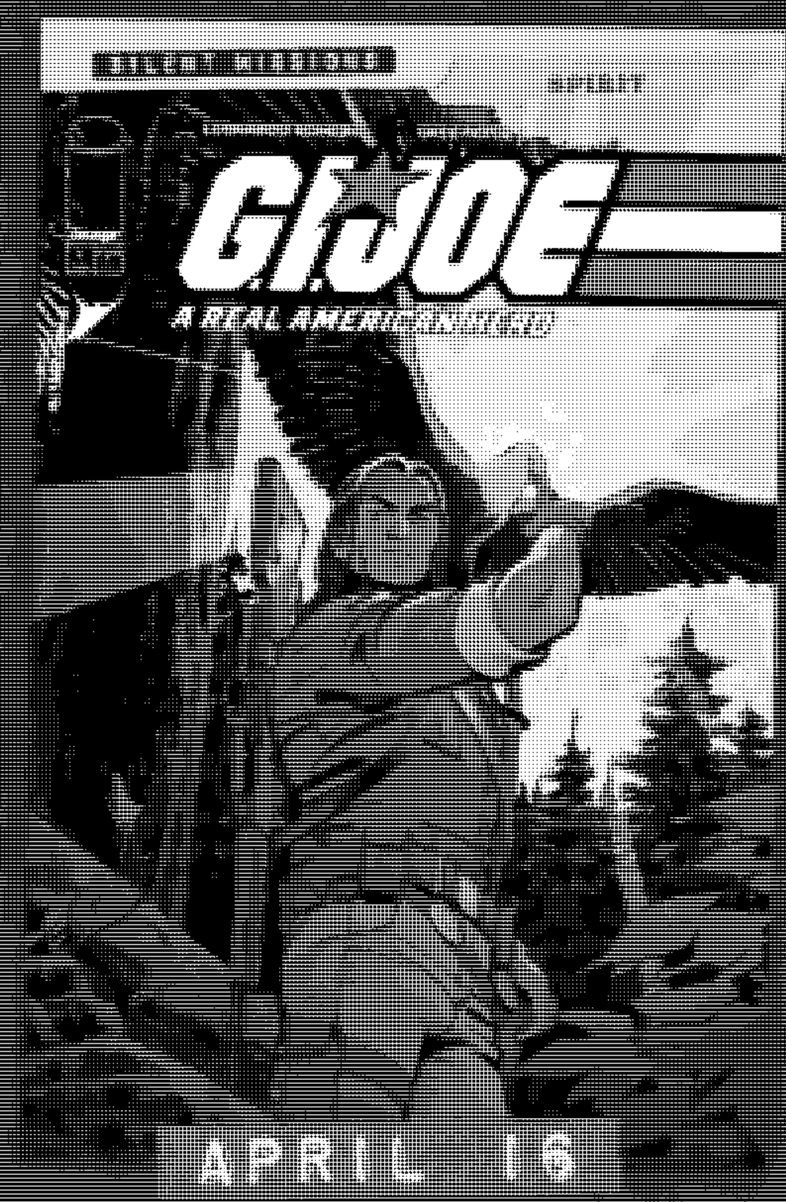

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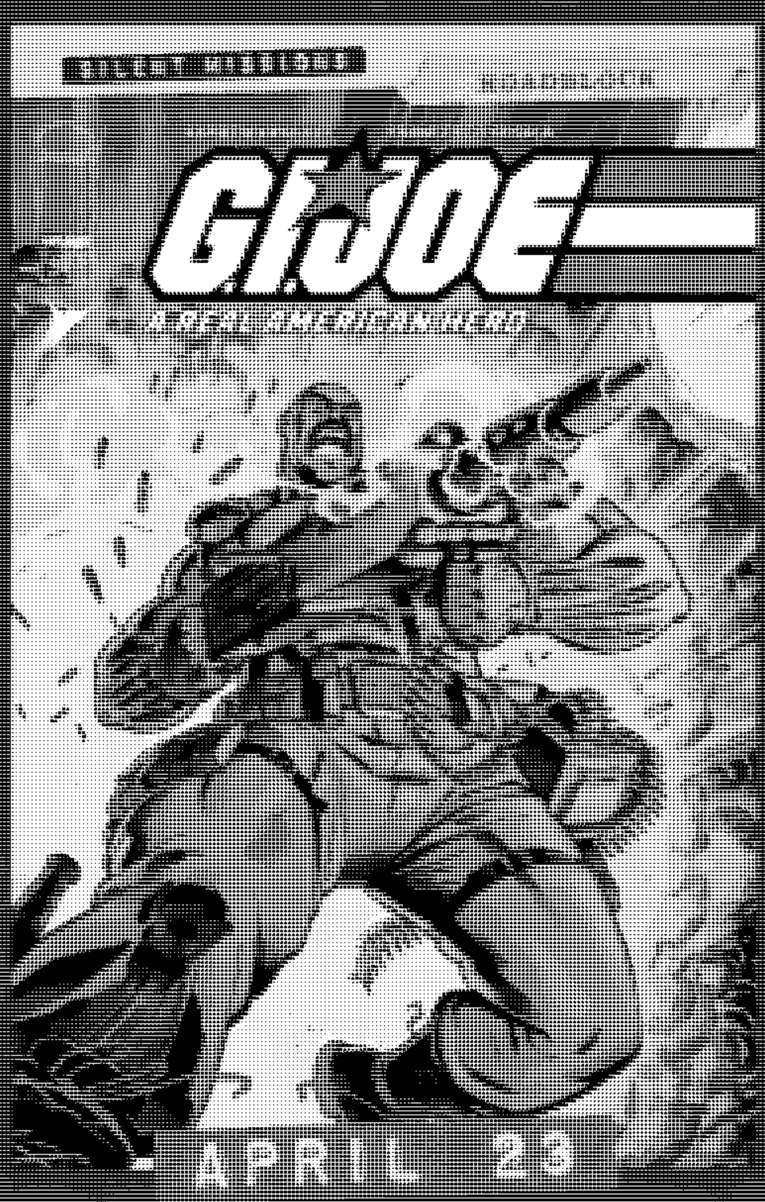

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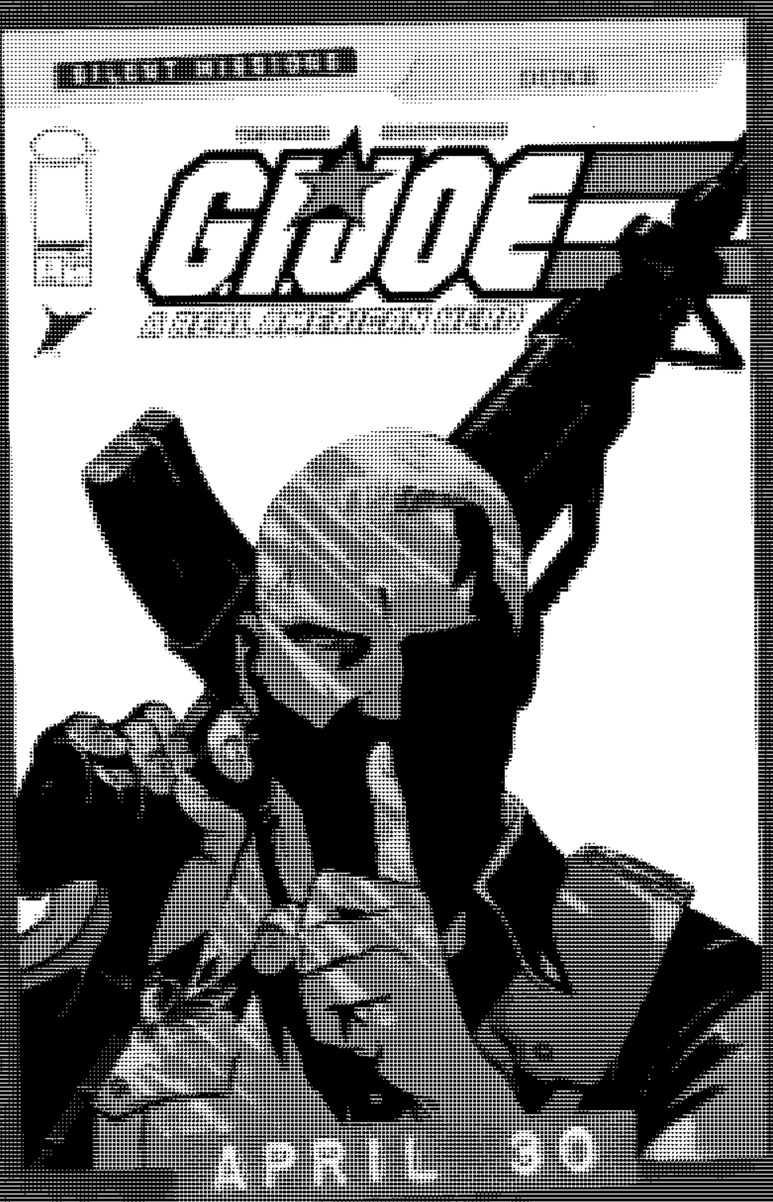

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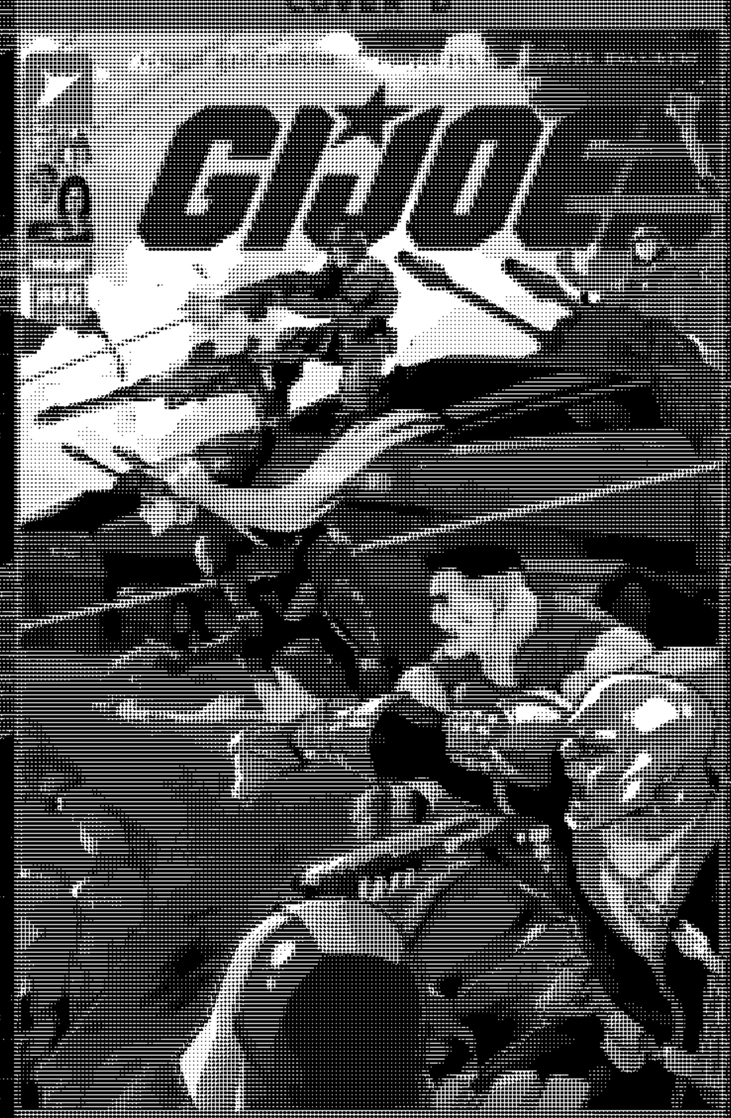

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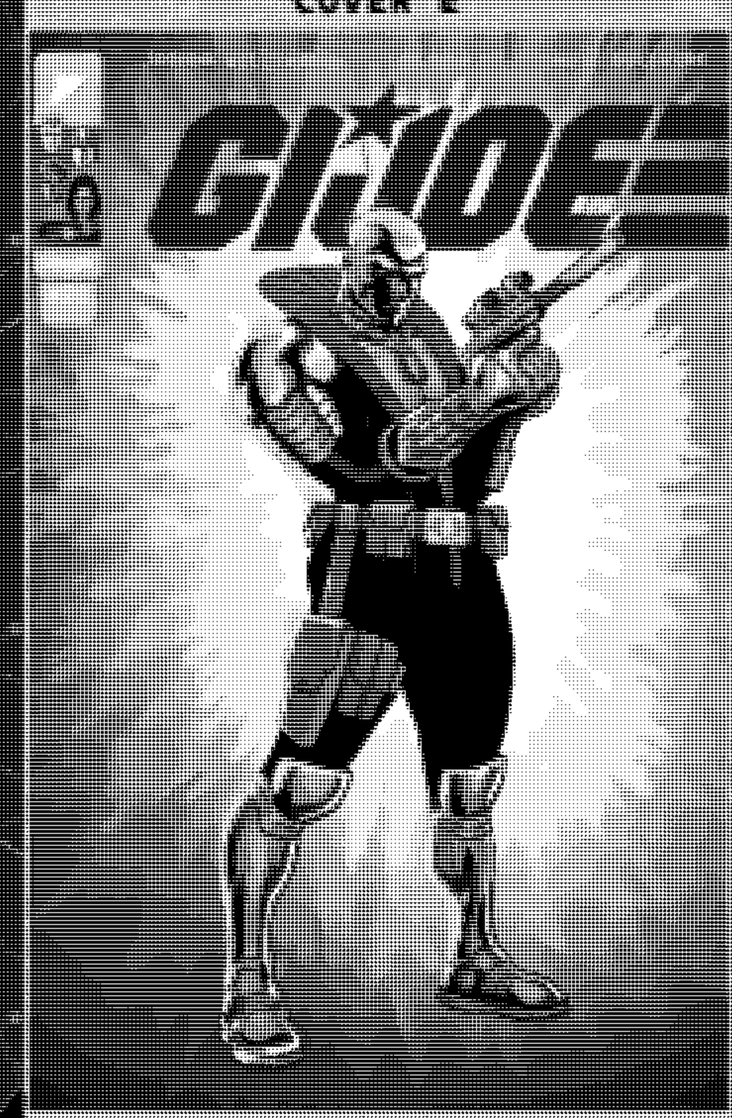

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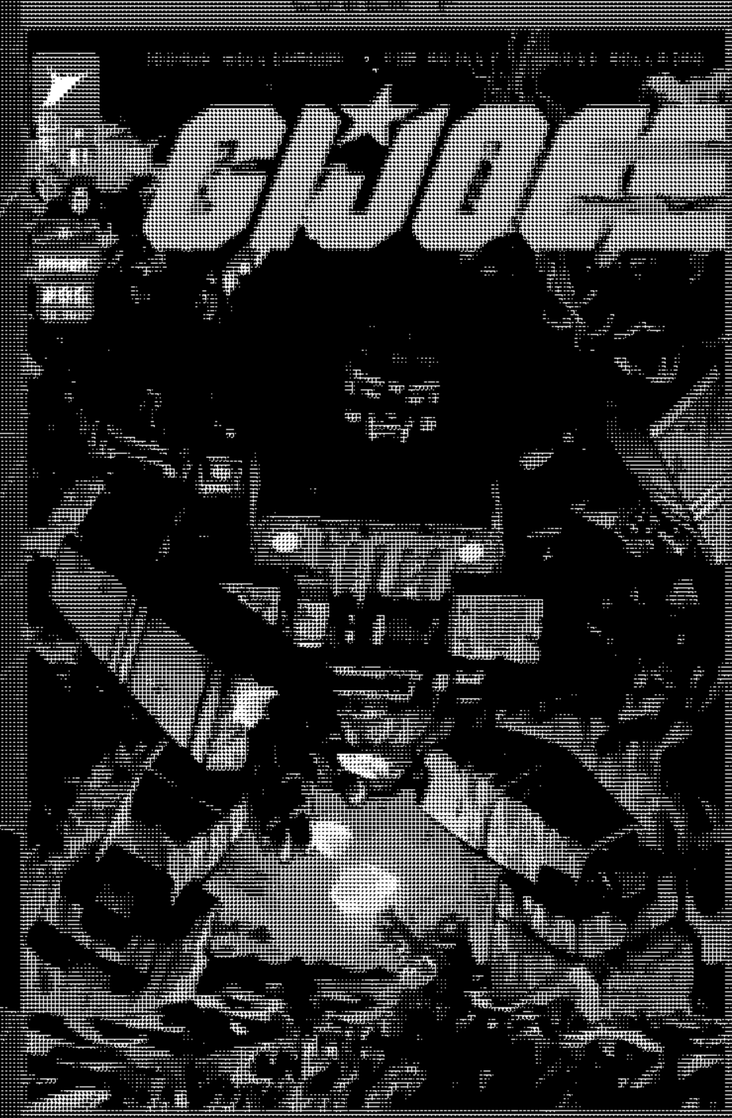

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